in his place. On another evening, that might have disrupted our rhythm. Another player than Trevor might have needed time to find the pace of a World Cup game. Instead, he just grabbed his moment. He started running at Argentina, terrorizing experienced defenders like Placente and Sorin. He was ready for this. It was his night to make sure all those miles in a 747, when he'd been in and out of the squad and finally in again, had been worth the flying.

Argentina had one or two scoring chances. We had better ones. Michael turned in the area and shot across their goalkeeper, Cavallero. I was already in the air, sure it was in, but the ball came backoff the far post. Then I found myself with the ball at my feet about six or seven yards outside the Argentina penalty area. Shoot or pass? I wanted to keep the ball moving: Michael was already making a run in behind one of their defenders. Suddenly, I'm knocked over. Someone had come in from behind and clipped the back of my heels. I had no idea which Argentine player had done it. I was sure it was a free-kick, though. Good range and position for me as well. I shouted out towards Pierluigi Collina, the referee. He'd spotted the foul but he'd also already seen something I hadn't and was playing advantage. I looked across. Twenty yards away from me, the ball had broken forward and suddenly Michael Owen had it and was twisting past Pochettino, just inside the box. The Argentine defender stuck a leg out as Michael edged beyond him.

'Penalty!'

I'm sure I shouted it out. I know every England supporter did. As I saw Michael tumble, I knew Collina would see it and would be brave enough to give it. He'd been strong enough to continue play when I'd screamed at him for my foul. There was a split second of *déjà vu*: I'd known I was going to score, hadn't I? I'd talked to Victoria about a winning goal and finally squaring away Simeone, the red card and Saint-Etienne. Had I dreamed this scene the night before? Or had I seen what was about to happen just before it did? As quickly as those thoughts were in my mind, they were gone. I had to get to the ball. I had to be the one to score. A hungry feeling, in the pit of my stomach: dread. And it wasn't a voice in my head exactly, but the realization, right then: *Everything else I've done in my life, everything that's ever happened to me: it's all been heading towards this.*

I knew Michael would be ready to take the penalty himself.

'Do you want me to have it?'

'No. I'm having it.'